

Damien GUESDON

DIRECTOR OF PLATFORM ENGINEERING / EX-CTO

Team Leadership, Critical Infrastructure & Kubernetes

La Plaine-sur-Mer, France (Full Remote)

guesdondamien@free.fr | +33 6 63 71 17 80



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 20 years of experience in critical infrastructures. As a former CTO managing an 18-person department, I drive platform growth by combining team structuring, operational rigor, and architectural vision. A strong advocate for autonomy to foster engagement, I deliberately maintain deep technical credibility (Kubernetes, networking, bare-metal) to fully understand the daily challenges of my engineers, supporting and constructively challenging them. Today, I actively integrate generative AI into my daily workflows as an accelerator for SRE and Platform automation, aiming to build scalable, enterprise-grade standards.

KEY SKILLS

- People & Engineering Leadership:
- Management of cross-functional teams, 1:1s, team restructuring by expertise hubs, fostering a culture of ownership and autonomy (remote & hybrid).
- Platform & Operations (SRE):
- Roadmap execution, SLA management, cross-department CAB processes, technical debt resolution, observability.
- Architecture & Infrastructure:
- OpenShift, Kubernetes, bare-metal, ISP networks. Highly available, critical, and air-gapped environments.
- Security & Compliance:
- Zero Trust, network segmentation. Strong background in designing foundations for ISO 27001 and HDS certified environments.
- AI-Assisted Engineering:
- Daily integration of Agentic/Generative AI (LLMs, RAG) for code generation, automation scripting, and internal tooling.

LANGUAGES

- French: Native
- English: Fluent (including technical)
- Catalan: In progress

EDUCATION

- Master of Science in AI Engineering, OpenClassrooms, 2026
- Specialization: Data Science and Machine Learning Operations.
- Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), IT Resource Mgmt, 2006
- IT Resource Management Specialist

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - Infrastructure – Alphalink

France – Jan 2024 – May 2025

 - Management & Organization:** Directly managed an 18-person engineering department. Restructured the team into 4 specialized hubs (VoIP, Network, R&D, Datacenter) with dedicated technical leads. Conducted recurring 1:1s and championed team autonomy to drive motivation and accountability.
 - Operational Excellence (SRE Processes):** Established a cross-department Change Advisory Board (CAB). Standardized deployment procedures including: strict planning, ownership assignment, risk assessment, impact forecasting, defined rollback procedures, and mandatory post-mortems within 48 hours.
 - Roadmap & Technical Debt:** Allocated a strict 20% of team capacity exclusively to resolving technical debt. Steered the global infrastructure roadmap and successfully secured SLAs for highly critical accounts.
 - Team Culture:** Cultivated strong team cohesion through regular events (afterworks) and informal touchpoints, fostering a collaborative environment suitable for modern engineering teams.
- Cloud Architecture & AI R&D – KISAI (Personal Project)

Remote – Since June 2025

 - Technical Credibility & Hands-On:** Maintaining sharp technical skills by deploying a bare-metal SNO OKD (OpenShift/Kubernetes) cluster from scratch. This hands-on approach allows me to intimately understand operational constraints.
 - AI-First Principle:** Developing "SophIA", a sovereign B2B AI platform. Leveraging generative AI daily to draft code, build automation scripts, and orchestrate infrastructure, allowing me to focus entirely on high-level architecture design and scalability.
- Senior Infrastructure & Network Consultant – KISAI (Freelance)

France / Remote – 2018 – 2023

 - Governance & Security:** Provided strategic guidance on operator and datacenter architectures. Built resilient structural foundations enabling the strict application of security standards (successfully supporting ISO 27001 and HDS accreditation renewals).
 - Complex Deployments:** Managed critical infrastructure migrations and technical coordination for major rollouts, including the architectural design of an ISP Security Operations Center (SOC) based on Palo Alto environments.
- Technical Director / Senior Consultant – Freelance

La Plaine-sur-Mer – 2011 – 2018

 - Deployed and managed operator backbones, datacenters, and MPLS networks.
 - Led network engineering and ISP service integrations, focusing on high availability designs.
- Previous Experience (SysAdmin & Network)

– 2005 – 2011

 - ALPHALINK** (2008-2011): Network Architect – Designed architectures, managed technical projects.
 - PYGRAM** (2007-08): Systems & Network Manager (VmWare, TSE).
 - Renault / BI-SAM / BNP Paribas** (2005-07): Systems Administrator & IT Support in large-scale enterprise environments.